

# Recovery Programme – Export Cable 2

Severn Subsea Cables Ltd · Doc. SSC-HB-PRG-0031 Rev 0

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## 1. Root cause

The root cause analysis (SSC-HB-RCA-0007, 7 August 2026) attributes the breakdown at factory joint FJ-2/07 to a contamination of the insulation interface during the moulding process, caused by a damaged filter in the clean-room air handling unit between 2 and 9 June 2026. Three factory joints were produced in that period, two of them in export cable 2 (FJ-2/07, FJ-2/08). Both will be removed.

## 2. Recovery plan

| Step                                                    | Start       | Finish      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|
| Cut-out of 9.2 km section incl. FJ-2/07 and FJ-2/08     | 17 Aug 2026 | 28 Aug 2026 |
| Re-manufacture of conductor and insulation (CCV line 2) | 31 Aug 2026 | 23 Oct 2026 |
| Armouring and new factory joints (2 ×)                  | 26 Oct 2026 | 4 Dec 2026  |
| Routine tests incl. HV AC test                          | 7 Dec 2026  | 22 Jan 2027 |
| Type test of revised factory joint (witnessed)          | 11 Jan 2027 | 5 Feb 2027  |
| Load-out readiness                                      | –           | 12 Mar 2027 |



*Export cable 2 on the turntable at Newport during cut-out preparation*

## 3. Measures to prevent recurrence

- Air handling filters replaced, monitoring of particle count with alarm

- 100 % X-ray of all factory joints for Harrow Bay
- Extended partial discharge test of all remaining factory joints (export cable 2 and array cables)

## 4. Impact

Delivery of export cable 2 moves from 15 January 2027 to 12 March 2027 (+56 days). Severn proposes to support the resequencing of the installation campaign so that export cable 1 is laid first.